

JESSIE JUAREZ · DIGITAL MEDIA STUDIO

AI Sales System

\$5K / Month

The exact stack, math, emails, and prompts to get there.

\$5,000

Monthly Revenue Goal

3–4

Agency Clients Needed

~50 min

Weekly Time Investment

\$140

Monthly Tool Cost

01 The Math

04 Email Templates

02 The Stack

05 AI Prompts

03 The System

06 Weekly Routine

The Math to \$5K/Month

You don't need dozens of clients. Three to four agencies paying project rates gets you there. Here's exactly how the numbers work:

3–4 Agency clients/month At ~\$1,500 per project	\$1,500 avg Per-project rate Short-form ads / brand video	50 min Weekly system time Outreach + reply management
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Revenue Scenarios

Scenario	Clients/Mo	Avg Project	Monthly Revenue	Notes
Conservative	3	\$1,250	\$3,750	1 project each, lower rate
On-target	4	\$1,350	\$5,400	Mix of 1–2 projects each
Growth	4–5	\$1,500	\$6,500–\$7,500	Repeat clients, larger scope
Retainer path	2	\$2,500/mo	\$5,000	2 agencies on monthly retainer

★ On-target row highlighted.

Tool Cost Breakdown

Tool	What It Does	Monthly Cost
Instantly.ai (Growth)	Send cold email sequences, warmup	\$47/mo
Apollo.io (Free tier)	Find agency contacts + emails	\$0 to start
Claude / Perplexity	Write emails, prompts, replies	Already have
Google Sheet	Lead tracking CRM	\$0
Sending domain	Subdomain for outreach inbox	~\$12/yr
TOTAL		~\$47–\$60/mo

The Minimal 3-Layer Stack

Layer	Tool	Purpose	Cost
1 · Prospecting	Apollo.io (free)	Find agency contacts + verified emails	\$0
2 · Outreach	Instantly.ai	Send sequences, warmup, track replies	\$47/mo
3 · AI Brain	Claude + Perplexity	Research, write emails, draft replies	Already have

The Automated System — Step by Step

01

Set up your sending domain

Buy a subdomain like outreach@studio.yourdomain.com from Namecheap (~\$12/yr). Connect it to Instantly.ai. Let it warm up for 14 days (Instantly does this automatically). Never send cold outreach from your main domain.

02

Build your first agency list with Apollo

Go to apollo.io → Search → Companies. Filter: Industry = Marketing/Advertising, Headcount = 5–50, Keywords = video ads OR social content OR e-commerce. Export 50 contacts with verified emails. Paste into your Google Sheet.

03

Write personalized intro lines with AI

For each agency, run Prompt 2 (page 5) in Claude or Perplexity. Takes 2–3 minutes per contact. Paste the best line into Column G of your Sheet. This is the only manual step — everything else is automated.

04

Upload contacts to Instantly + launch sequence

Import your Sheet into Instantly. Map the custom field {{intro_line}} to Column G. Create your 3-step sequence (templates on next page). Hit launch. Instantly sends, follows up, and tracks everything automatically.

05

Manage replies with AI

When a reply comes in, paste it into Claude with Prompt 3 (page 5). Approve the suggested reply with minor edits. Book calls or accept briefs. Repeat. Your goal is 2–3 positive conversations per week.

Email Sequence Templates

Copy these into Instantly as 3 steps in one sequence. The variable `{{intro_line}}` auto-inserts the personalized line you wrote with AI for each contact.

Step 1 — Day 1 | The Hook

Subject options (A/B test both):

quick question, `{{company_name}}`
video editing help for overflow work

Body:

`{{intro_line}}`

I'm Jessie, a video editor who specializes in short-form ads and brand video. I work with agencies on overflow – no retainer, just project by project.

Do you ever bring in freelance editors when things get busy?

– Jessie
[Portfolio link] | [Reel link]

Step 2 — Day 5 | The Bump

Subject:

Re: (same thread – leave blank)

Body:

Just wanted to float this back up – happy to share a quick reel if that makes it easier to evaluate.

– Jessie

Step 3 — Day 14 | The Close

Subject:

Re: (same thread – leave blank)

Body:

No worries if the timing isn't right. Feel free to keep this on file for whenever overflow editing comes up – I stay booked but always try to make room for agency work.

– Jessie

Deliverability rules

- • Send max 30–40 emails/day per inbox during warmup (first 2 weeks).
- • After warmup: 50–80/day per inbox is safe.
- • Always use a subdomain — never your main domain.
- • Keep subject lines under 8 words. No ALL CAPS. No exclamation marks.

AI Prompt Playbook

Use these prompts in Perplexity or Claude. Copy, fill in the brackets, run.

Prompt 1 — Build an Agency List (run in Perplexity)

Find 10 small to mid-size creative or marketing agencies in the US (5–50 people) that produce video ads or social content for e-commerce brands. For each agency return: name, website URL, one sentence on what they do, and any public-facing contact name or email for a creative lead, founder, or director. Do not include large holding companies.

Tip: Run 3–5 times with variations: 'DTC ad agencies', 'performance creative studios', 'social video agencies'. Target 50 total rows in your Sheet.

Prompt 2 — Write Personalized Intro Lines (run in Claude)

Here is an agency website copy: [paste their About page or homepage text].

Write 3 short personalized opening lines for a cold email I am sending them. Each line should be under 20 words, reference something specific about their work, clients, or style, and feel like a genuine human observation — not a generic compliment. No "I love your work" type lines.

Tip: Pick the best line and paste it into Column G of your Sheet. This becomes the `{{intro_line}}` variable in Instantly.

Prompt 3 — Draft a Reply (run in Claude when a lead responds)

I am a freelance video editor. Here is an email reply I received from an agency:
[paste their reply]

Draft a response that: confirms my interest in working together, asks one clarifying question about their typical project type or volume, and proposes a 15-minute intro call or says I am happy to share my reel first. Keep it under 100 words. Relaxed but professional tone.

Tip: Edit lightly so it sounds like you. Approve and send.

Weekly Routine + 90-Day Milestones

Weekly Routine (~50 minutes total)

Day	Task	Tool	Time
Monday	Run Prompt 1 — add 10 new agencies to Sheet	Perplexity	10 min
Monday	Run Prompt 2 — write intro lines for contacts	Claude	15 min
Monday	Upload contacts to Instantly, launch new batch	Instantly	5 min
Tue–Fri	Check dashboard for new replies	Instantly	5 min/day
Tue–Fri	Run Prompt 3 on replies, send approved draft	Claude	10 min
Friday	Review weekly stats: sent / opened / replied	Instantly	5 min

90-Day Milestone Map

Week 1–2 Setup • Buy subdomain, connect to Instantly • Let inbox warm up (automated) • Open Apollo free account • Build first 50-row Sheet	Week 3–4 First Sends • Run first campaign (30 contacts) • Measure: open rate target >40%, reply target >3% • Refine subject lines based on open rate • Aim for 2–3 positive replies	Month 2 First Client • Convert 1 positive reply into a paid project • Deliver great work, ask for referral • Scale to 50–80 sends/day • Add 20 new contacts/week	Month 3 \$5K Run Rate • 3–4 agencies in active rotation • 1–2 on soft retainer or repeat projects • System runs on ~50 min/week • Upgrade Apollo for more exports if needed
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The one metric that matters

Positive reply rate — not open rate, not send volume. A positive reply means someone said 'yes we use freelancers' or 'tell me more'. Your goal is 2–3 of those per week. That's enough to book 1–2 projects per month within 60 days of launching.

1. Instantly.ai Pricing, <https://instantly.ai/pricing>
2. Smartlead Pricing Guide 2026, <https://www.landbase.com/blog/smartlead-pricing>
3. Cold Outreach Automation Guide, <https://easyclaw.com/blog/knowledge/cold-outreach-automation/>
4. Cold Email Best Practices 2026, <https://expandi.io/blog/cold-email-outreach-best-practices/>